Medication Dispensing Policy

SHIFA General Hospital (Fictional)

DEMO / SYNTHETIC HOSPITAL DATA — NOT FOR REAL CLINICAL USE

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1. Purpose

This policy ensures that every medicine dispensed at SHIFA General Hospital is correct, safe and properly labelled. It applies to all pharmacists and pharmacy technicians. The Pharmacy main extension is 1500.

2. Valid Prescription

A medicine is dispensed only against a valid prescription or medication order that contains:

- Patient name and MRN.
- Age, and body weight for children.
- Generic drug name, strength, dose, route, frequency and duration.
- Prescriber name, signature and PMDC registration number.
- Date of the prescription.

Incomplete or unclear prescriptions are returned to the prescriber for clarification. Pharmacy staff must never guess.

3. Pharmacist Verification

Before dispensing, the pharmacist checks: known allergies (see the red wristband in PS-01), correct dose for age and weight, drug interactions, and duplicate therapy. High-alert medicines follow PH-02.

4. Labelling and Counselling

Every dispensed medicine is labelled with the patient name, MRN, drug name, strength, dose, frequency, expiry date and special instructions. The pharmacist counsels patients receiving discharge medicines and anyone receiving a medicine for the first time.

5. Inpatient Dispensing

The Inpatient Pharmacy supplies wards with unit-dose medicines. Routine orders are delivered within 30 minutes of receiving the order and STAT (urgent) orders within 15 minutes.

6. Controlled Drugs

Controlled drugs are dispensed only against a controlled drug prescription signed by a consultant. They are dispensed only by the Inpatient Pharmacy and the Emergency Pharmacy. They are stored in a double-lock cabinet. Two authorised persons count them at every shift change and sign the register. Any discrepancy is reported immediately to the Pharmacy In-charge.

7. Verbal Orders

Verbal orders are accepted only in emergencies. The receiver writes the order down, reads it

back to the doctor and the doctor signs it within 24 hours.

8. Restricted Antibiotics

Restricted antibiotics are dispensed only after approval from the Infectious Disease consultant.

9. Expired Medicines and Returns

Expired medicines are never dispensed. Items within 90 days of expiry are separated and marked. Once a medicine has left the pharmacy it cannot be returned to stock, except when the pharmacy made a dispensing error.